

AI Tools Like ChatGPT

A visual guide to the most useful AI assistants for work, learning, coding, research, design and productivity

**BEGINNER-FRIENDLY
GUIDE**

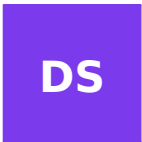
Chat • Create • Analyze • Code • Research

What is a general-purpose AI assistant?

It is a tool that can understand natural-language instructions and help you write, summarize, explain, brainstorm, analyze files, generate ideas and often work with images or code.

1. Main AI Assistants

These are the most popular all-round tools for everyday use.

 ChatGPT OpenAI Writing, coding, analysis, files, images and general assistance.	 Microsoft Copilot Microsoft Best suited to Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Outlook and Windows.	 Gemini Google Useful with Google Search, Gmail, Drive, Docs and Android.
 Claude Anthropic Strong for long documents, thoughtful writing, analysis and coding.	 Perplexity Perplexity AI Excellent for internet research with references and citations.	 Grok xAI General assistance with access to current discussions and content from X.
 Meta AI Meta Built into WhatsApp, Instagram, Facebook and Messenger.	 DeepSeek DeepSeek Known for reasoning, mathematics, programming and technical tasks.	 Le Chat Mistral AI General-purpose writing, document work and coding assistance.

2. Quick Comparison

Choose the tool based on what you want to achieve.

Tool	Best for	Good choice when...
ChatGPT	All-round use	You want one flexible assistant for writing, coding, learning and files.
Copilot	Microsoft 365	Most of your work happens in Word, Excel, PowerPoint and Outlook.
Gemini	Google ecosystem	You use Gmail, Docs, Drive, Search or Android frequently.
Claude	Long documents	You need clear analysis, polished writing or large-document review.
Perplexity	Research	You want web-based answers with visible sources.
DeepSeek	Technical reasoning	You need help with coding, mathematics or logical problem-solving.

Best overall starting point ChatGPT	Best for Office users Microsoft Copilot	Best for research Perplexity
Best for Google users Gemini	Best for long documents Claude	Best for technical reasoning DeepSeek

3. AI Tools by Purpose

Specialized tools can be better than general chatbots for focused tasks.

Coding	GitHub Copilot • Cursor • Windsurf • Claude Code • Amazon Q Developer Use these for code completion, debugging, refactoring and software development.
Images	Midjourney • Adobe Firefly • DALL-E • Leonardo AI • Canva AI Use these to create illustrations, posters, marketing images and design concepts.
Presentations	Gamma • Beautiful.ai • Canva • Tome • Microsoft Copilot Use these to generate slide structure, layouts, visuals and presentation content.
Video	Runway • Synthesia • HeyGen • Pika • Google Veo Use these for AI video generation, avatars, effects, editing and explainer videos.
Research & Documents	NotebookLM • Perplexity • Elicit • Consensus • SciSpace Use these to summarize sources, understand documents and support research work.
Meetings	Otter.ai • Fireflies.ai • Fathom • Zoom AI Companion Use these for transcription, meeting summaries, action items and follow-up notes.

4. Recommended Starter Toolkit

You do not need every tool. Start with a small combination that covers most needs.

1

ChatGPT
General work, learning, writing, coding and file analysis

2

Microsoft Copilot or Gemini
Choose based on whether you use Microsoft 365 or Google Workspace

3

Perplexity
Use for research and source-based web answers

4

NotebookLM
Use for studying, summarizing and querying your own documents

5

Canva AI or Gamma
Use for visual content and presentations

Simple tips for using AI tools effectively

- Give clear instructions: mention the task, audience, tone and expected output.
- Provide context and examples instead of asking a very broad question.
- Review important facts, numbers and recommendations before using them.
- Avoid uploading confidential or sensitive information unless your organization permits it.
- Use AI as an assistant for thinking and productivity - not as a replacement for human judgment.

Best tools to learn first
ChatGPT • Microsoft Copilot • Gemini • Claude • Perplexity •
NotebookLM

Together, these cover most daily needs in writing, productivity, research, documents and learning.